

Launch & Marketing Plan — Project 0

Show, don't tell. The hiring evaluator should see irresistible project thumbnails — each solving a materially different business problem — and feel compelled to click. 80%+ of visitors should find at least one project that directionally maps to a problem their company needs solved.

Launch trigger & timeline

Condition	Definition	Status
Soft launch — now	Site is live. URL shared selectively with known contacts and included in targeted applications. No broad distribution. Audience is warm contacts and specific bootcamp/cohort contexts only.	Active
Full launch trigger	P0 UI/UX iteration complete AND minimum three portfolio-worthy projects showcased. Each project solves a materially different, evaluator-relevant business problem.	Pending
Full launch deadline	180 days from today — hard constraint. Stretch target 100 days. Probable target 150 days. This deadline is non-negotiable.	180-day clock running
LinkedIn activation	URL added to LinkedIn profile when full launch trigger is met — not before. Premature LinkedIn distribution exposes an incomplete product to the highest-value channel.	Deferred

Audience map — who, channel, timing

Audience	Channel	Timing	Note
Known PM contact	Zoom — URL in chat	Completed — soft launch	Wrong benchmark. Evaluating code depth, not PM artifacts. Signal: not the right demo audience yet.
Backend dev — meetup	In-person — live URL	Completed — soft launch	Wrong audience. Frontend-only portfolio at a backend dev showcase. No signal value. No action required.
Product bootcamp / cohort	Application — URL included	Completed — accepted	Signal is in the work produced inside the cohort, not the acceptance. All applicants accepted.
X.com (pinned profile)	Public profile link	Active now — UTM needed	UTM parameter required before Phase 9 measurement begins. See UTM section below.
LinkedIn	Profile URL field	Deferred — full launch trigger	Highest-value channel. Only activated when product is showcase-ready with 3+ portfolio projects.

Associate PM job applications	Application — URL field	Deferred — full launch trigger	Primary conversion channel. Activated at full launch trigger only. Every application before that trigger is a rehearsal.
Hiring evaluators — direct	Email / referral	Deferred — full launch trigger	Target audience. Not yet reached directly. This is the audience the entire product is built for.

UTM parameter structure — Phase 9 measurement enablement

UTM parameters are appended to the portfolio URL so GA4 can attribute each visit to its source. Without UTMs, all traffic appears as Direct in GA4 and channel performance is invisible. Two UTMs are required before Phase 9 begins.

Channel	UTM Source	UTM Medium	UTM Campaign	Full URL pattern
X.com pinned profile	twitter	social	p0-soft-launch	thepmdev.com/?utm_source=twitter&utm_medium=social&utm_campaign=p0-soft-launch
LinkedIn profile	linkedin	social	p0-full-launch	thepmdev.com/?utm_source=linkedin&utm_medium=social&utm_campaign=p0-full-launch
Job applications	job-app	referral	p0-applications	thepmdev.com/?utm_source=job-app&utm_medium=referral&utm_campaign=p0-applications
Direct / email	direct-outreach	email	p0-outreach	thepmdev.com/?utm_source=direct-outreach&utm_medium=email&utm_campaign=p0-outreach

Action required before Phase 9: Replace the X.com pinned URL with the UTM-tagged version. LinkedIn and job application UTMs activated at full launch trigger.

P0 v2 — homepage vision (locked for UI/UX iteration phase)

The following direction was defined during Phase 8 and is locked as the creative brief for the P0 UI/UX iteration. It does not get built now. It gets built after the full launch trigger conditions are understood and at least one portfolio project exists to populate it.

Show, don't tell — homepage vision Multiple irresistible project thumbnail teasers — each showcasing a solution to a materially different business problem relevant to hiring evaluators. Each thumbnail communicates the problem solved: drive revenue, reduce churn, improve efficiencies, reduce costs, increase engagement. The evaluator self-selects the one that maps to their company's current need. 80%+ of visitors find at least one project that directionally resonates. This is the primary UX success metric for the homepage. Clicking a thumbnail is the primary conversion action. Everything else on the page exists to make that click feel inevitable.	What the homepage will not be No 'About Me' word wall. No predictable work history recitation. No FAANG name-dropping. No passion statements. No years-of-experience counters. Nobody has time to read it. Nobody will. The evaluator has 30 seconds. Every word that isn't a project thumbnail is a word that competes with the thing that actually converts. This is a product portfolio, not a resume rendered as a webpage. The work speaks. The page gets out of the way.
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Project classification — learning projects vs. portfolio projects

Not every project ships to the portfolio. This distinction was surfaced during Phase 8 and is a foundational sequencing decision for all future projects.

Type	Definition	Goes to portfolio?	Example
Learning project	Exists to build a specific technical or PM capability. The output is skill, not showcase. Completed to the same PMD process standard but not featured on thepmdev.com.	No — internal only	A CRUD app built to learn database fundamentals. Valuable. Not evaluator-relevant.
Portfolio project	Solves a real, specific, evaluator-relevant problem. Demonstrates PM thinking, technical execution, and business acumen simultaneously. Featured on thepmdev.com.	Yes — full showcase	A churn prediction dashboard built for a SaaS context. Solves a named problem hiring managers recognise immediately.
Classification trigger	The question is: would a hiring evaluator see this project thumbnail and feel the problem it solves is relevant to their company? If yes — portfolio. If no — learning.	Decided at P1 kickoff per project	Classification happens at roadmap phase, not after build. Prevents building the wrong thing at the wrong depth.

Open items — Phase 8 actions

Item	Action required	When
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X.com UTM	Replace pinned URL with UTM-tagged version: thepmdev.com/?utm_source=twitter&utm_medium=social&utm_campaign=p0-soft-launch	Before Phase 9 begins
Footer email placeholder	Replace hello@thepmdev.com with live purpose-built contact address before sharing site with evaluators.	Before full launch
GA4 measurement ID	Replace GA_MEASUREMENT_ID placeholder in index.html with live GA4 property ID.	Before Phase 9 begins
LinkedIn activation	Add UTM-tagged URL to LinkedIn profile. Activate only at full launch trigger — minimum three portfolio projects live.	Full launch trigger
P0 v2 UI/UX brief	Homepage vision locked in this document. PRD amendment and wireframe pass to be scoped after P1 project classification is complete.	Post-P1 kickoff